

# “We have the benefits of AI to help us evolve”

Raynald Aeschlimann, President and CEO of OMEGA, and Alain Zobrist, CEO of Swiss Timing, on The Swatch Group's legacy, innovation, and more

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**OMEGA, THE OFFICIAL timekeeper of the Olympics since 1932, has stayed committed to precision, innovation, and excellence. From the early days of stopwatches to AI-powered systems that capture the nuances of athletic performance, OMEGA's journey reflects the commitment to pushing boundaries. In conversation with BUSINESS TODAY, Raynald Aeschlimann, President and CEO of OMEGA and Alain Zobrist, CEO of Swiss Timing Ltd (both are part of The Swatch Group), provide a glimpse of the future of timekeeping. Edited excerpts:**

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**How has OMEGA's partnership with the Olympic Games shaped the company's identity?**

Raynald Aeschlimann: The Olympics have become a defining part of OMEGA's DNA and it represents our values of precision, excellence, reliability, and innovation. For the past 92

years, the world has seen our name being associated with the greatest sporting moments, which has naturally built a reputation of trust. Innovation is a critical part of what we do. As the athletes go 'faster, higher, stronger', our technology also needs to keep up the pace. Therefore, we have been committed to

On a practical level, we have approached each sport individually, and this has been driven by technological advancements in each era. Today, we have the benefits of AI to help us evolve again. One of the greatest innovations came in 1968, when we introduced touchpads in swimming.

of a swimmer. Working with AI systems, our Computer Vision is now able to reproduce an exact 3D vision of any performance. This will help detect precise details.

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**OMEGA has a rich history of pushing boundaries—from the**

## “OUR COMPUTER VISION IS NOW ABLE TO REPRODUCE AN EXACT 3D VISION OF ANY [SPORTING] PERFORMANCE”

developing revolutionary equipment. Our legacy at the Olympics is built on pushing the boundaries of timekeeping and delivering modern technology.

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**How has the approach to timekeeping evolved?**

RA: OMEGA is a pioneering brand. That is true in our watchmaking, and also in our timekeeping.

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**What impact will the innovations have on the (Olympic) Games and the future of sports timekeeping?**

RA: The big advancement right now is our Computer Vision technology. We can now capture a range of performance data—from the acceleration of a sprinter to the number of strokes

**Moon landing to its association with James Bond films. How does this spirit of exploration translate into the vision for the future of horological innovation?**

RA: Our history motivates us. But these things you mention, such as the Moon or James Bond, are the authentic results of our quality. The lesson is that we need to keep